

Word family: **tick / ticks / ticked / ticking / ticker**

Base word: tick

Forms: ticks, ticked, ticking

Related form: ticker

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> "...it has sentimental value, so it **ticks all the boxes** for me."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **tick all the boxes** is a fixed figurative expression meaning **to satisfy all the important requirements, preferences, or criteria**.

繁體中文： **符合所有要求；各方面都合乎理想；所有條件都滿足**

中文翻譯：

> "...so it **ticks all the boxes** for me."

「.....所以對我來說，它可算是**各方面都符合我的要求 / 面面俱到**。」

The image comes from a checklist:

> ☒ practical

> ☒ stylish

> ☒ sentimental value

If every relevant box gets a **tick**, everything wanted has been satisfied.

1. **tick = short regular clicking sound (聲音) — 滴答聲；嗒嗒聲**

Meaning: A short, light clicking sound, especially one repeated regularly by a clock or mechanical device.

Practice 1

> "I could hear the **tick** of the clock."

「我聽到時鐘的**滴答聲**。」

Practice 2

> “The steady **tick** filled the quiet room.”

「規律的**滴答聲**充滿了安靜的房間。」

tick = 時鐘、機械等發出的短促規律聲音

Common:

* tick of a clock

* steady tick

* ticking sound

2. **tick** = make a regular clicking sound (動詞) — 發出滴答聲

Practice 3

> “The clock was **ticking** loudly.”

「時鐘正大聲**滴答作響**。」

Practice 4

> “I could hear the timer **tick**.”

「我可以聽到計時器**滴答作響**。」

tick = 持續發出短促、有規律的聲音

This is the verb counterpart of Meaning 1.

3. **tick** = check mark ✓ (符號) — 剔號 ; 勾號

Especially in British English, a **tick** is the mark **✓** showing that something is correct, selected, completed, or approved.

Practice 5

> “Put a **tick** beside the correct answer.”

「在正確答案旁邊打一個**剔號 / 勾號**。」

Practice 6

> “Every item had a **tick** next to it.”

「每一項旁邊都有一個**勾號**。」

tick = 用來表示正確、完成、選中或符合要求的 ✓ 記號

In American English, **check mark** is generally more common.

4. **tick** = mark something with a ✓ (動詞) — 打勾 ; 剔選

Practice 7

> “**Tick** the box if you agree.”

「如果你同意，就在方格內**打勾**。」

Practice 8

> “I **ticked** all the items I had completed.”

「我把所有已完成項目都**打了勾**。」

tick something = 用 ✓ 標示某項為正確、完成或已選擇

This is the literal source of your passage expression.

5. **tick all the boxes** = satisfy all requirements (固定表達) — 符合所有條件 ; 面面俱到

This is the exact construction in your passage.

Practice 9 — Original

> “The jacket **ticks all the boxes** for me.”

「這件外套對我來說**各方面都符合要求**。」

Practice 10

> “The apartment is affordable, convenient, and spacious, so it **ticks all the boxes**.”

「這間公寓價格合理、方便又寬敞，所以**完全符合所有要求**。」

Practice 11

> “She wanted a job with flexible hours and good pay, and this one **ticks all the boxes**.”

「她想要工時彈性、薪酬好的工作，而這份工作**所有條件都符合**。」

tick all the boxes = 一項項檢視條件後，發現所有重要要求都符合

This is a fixed figurative expression rather than a separate basic meaning.

6. **tick = small blood-feeding parasite (動物) — 蜱；壁蝨**

A **tick** is a small arachnid that attaches itself to animals or people and feeds on blood.

Practice 12

> “The dog had a **tick** on its leg.”

「那隻狗腿上有一隻**蜱蟲**。」

Practice 13

> “Wear long trousers in areas where **ticks** are common.”

「在常有**蜱蟲**出沒的地方應穿長褲。」

tick = 吸附在人或動物皮膚上吸血的小型蛛形綱寄生生物

This is a completely separate noun meaning.

7. **tick = a very short moment (英式口語) — 一會兒；片刻**

In British informal English, **a tick** can mean a very short time.

Practice 14

> “Wait a **tick**.”

「等**一會兒**。」

Practice 15

> “I’ll be with you in a **tick**.”

「我**馬上 / 一會兒**就來。」

a tick = 非常短的一段時間

This probably develops metaphorically from the brief tick of a clock.

8. **tick = one small unit/change on a scale (刻度 / 變動單位) — 一格 ; 最小變動單位**

In technical contexts, **tick** can mean one division or minimal movement on a scale, chart, market price, timer, etc.

Practice 16

> “The pointer moved up one **tick**.”

「指針向上移了一**格**。」

Practice 17

> “The contract price moved by one **tick**.”

「合約價格變動了一個最小**跳動單位**。」

tick = 刻度、價格或其他數值中一次最小的離散變化

This is especially established in:

- * finance
- * trading
- * charts
- * computing/timers

9. **tick = smallest price movement in trading (金融) — 最小價格跳動**

In financial markets, a **tick** is the minimum permitted price movement of a traded instrument.

Examples:

* tick size
* uptick
* downtick

Practice 18

> “The market moved up several **ticks**.”

「市場價格上升了幾個最小**跳動單位**。」

This is a specialist but established branch of Meaning 8.

10. **tick** = one timing/event cycle in computing or electronics (科技) — 時脈 / 計時單位

In computing or digital systems, a **tick** can mean one discrete timer, clock, simulation, or processing interval.

Practice 19

> “The game updates once per clock **tick**.”

「遊戲每個時脈**週期 / 計時單位**更新一次。」

Practice 20

> “The simulation advances one **tick** at a time.”

「模擬系統每次前進一個**時間步**。」

This is an established technical extension of the repeated-clock concept.

11. **on tick** = on credit (英式非正式) — 賒帳 ; 先取貨後付款

This is a fixed British informal expression.

Practice 21

> “He bought the goods **on tick**.”

「他是**賒帳**買這批貨的。」

Practice 22

> “The shop no longer sells anything ****on tick****.”

「這間店已不再讓人****賒帳購物****。」

****on tick** = 先取得商品，之後才付款******

This is lexicalized and should be stored as a fixed expression, not another everyday bare-word meaning.

12. ****tick** = function satisfactorily / continue operating (固定比喻) — 運作******

The core clock metaphor also appears in expressions such as:

> ****what makes someone/something tick****

Practice 23

> “I want to understand what makes the organization ****tick****.”

「我想了解這個組織究竟靠甚麼****運作 / 其運作原理是甚麼****。」

Practice 24

> “Psychologists are interested in what makes people ****tick****.”

「心理學家很想知道人們內在的****動機和運作方式****。」

****what makes X tick** = 是甚麼令 X 運作；某人真正的動機 / 思維機制是甚麼******

This is an important idiomatic extension of the clock sense.

13. ****tick over** = continue running slowly (片語) — 低速運轉******

Especially of an engine:

> “The engine was ticking over.”

「引擎正在****怠速運轉****。」

Figuratively, a business or system can ****tick over****, meaning continue operating at a low/basic level.

Because this is a phrasal verb and not part of the target sentence, I would keep it outside the bare-word core.

14. **tick off = mark completed items / reprimand (片語) **

This phrasal verb has two important senses:

tick off items

= 在清單上逐項打勾

tick someone off

in British English = 責罵某人

In American English, **tick someone off** can also mean:

> make someone angry

These are useful, but because our SOP excludes phrasal verbs by default unless targeted, I would record them as extensions rather than core **tick** senses.

Related form: **ticking**

Ticking can mean the repeated tick sound.

Practice 25

> “The **ticking** of the clock kept me awake.”

「時鐘的**滴答聲**令我睡不着。」

It can also be used in compounds:

> ticking clock

literally a clock making tick sounds, or figuratively something with limited time remaining.

Related form: **ticker**

****Ticker**** has several established meanings.

**ticker = device/feed showing changing information (資訊顯示器) **

Historically, a stock ticker printed price information.

Modern uses include:

- * stock ticker
- * news ticker
- * scrolling ticker

Practice 26

> “The share price appeared on the stock ****ticker****.”

「股價顯示在股票****行情顯示器****上。」

**ticker = heart (非正式) — 心臟******

Informally, especially in British English:

> “He has a weak ****ticker****.”

「他的****心臟****不太好。」

This is lexicalized and informal.

Related form: **tick-box**

****Tick-box**** can literally mean a box designed to be ticked.

It also has a figurative adjective use:

> ****tick-box exercise****

meaning an activity done merely to satisfy formal requirements rather than achieve meaningful results.

Practice 27

> “The review should not become a **tick-box exercise**.”

「這項檢討不應淪為只求形式上過關的**打勾式程序**。」

This is a useful compound extension of the checklist sense.

Important distinction: **tick vs check**

For the ✓ mark:

British English

> tick / tick a box

American English

> check mark / check a box

Both are widely understood, but usage preference differs.

Important distinction: **tick vs cross**

tick ✓

usually means:

- * correct
- * selected
- * completed

cross ✕

often means:

- * incorrect
- * rejected

But forms and questionnaires can define symbols differently.

Important distinction: **tick vs mark**

mark

is broad.

tick

specifically often refers to the ✓ symbol.

> mark the answer

> tick the answer

The second tells you more about the type of mark.

Important distinction: **tick vs click**

tick

usually suggests a small, regular mechanical sound.

click

is a sharper individual sound and need not repeat rhythmically.

> clock ticks

> mouse clicks

Important distinction: **tick vs beat**

tick

= clock-like clicking unit

beat

= rhythmic pulse, especially heart/music

> ticking clock

> heartbeat

They can metaphorically overlap but are not the same.

Grammar note: **tick a box / tick something off**

Natural:

- > tick the box
- > tick the correct answer
- > tick the item off the list

For your expression:

- > **tick all the boxes**

the boxes are metaphorical criteria.

Countability note

Tick is countable in its main noun senses:

- * a tick of the clock
- * a tick on a form
- * a tick parasite
- * a tick on a scale
- * wait a tick

The meaning therefore depends heavily on context.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **tick**
- * **ticks**
- * **ticked**
- * **ticking**
- * **ticker**

Useful compounds/constructions:

- * tick box
- * tick all the boxes

- * tick-box exercise
- * ticking clock
- * stock ticker
- * news ticker
- * tick size
- * on tick
- * what makes someone tick

Phrasal verbs such as **tick off** and **tick over** are useful but should remain separate extensions unless directly targeted.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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tick — sound	時鐘 / 機械發出的短促規律滴答聲
tick — verb, sound	發出規律的滴答聲
tick — check mark	表示正確、完成或已選擇的 ✓ 勾號
tick — mark with ✓	在項目或方格上打勾
tick all the boxes	符合所有重要要求、條件或偏好
tick — parasite	吸附在人 / 動物皮膚上吸血的蜱蟲
a tick — moment	非常短的一會兒；英式口語
tick — scale/unit	刻度或數值的一個最小變動單位
tick — finance	金融商品價格的最小跳動幅度
tick — computing	一個時脈、計時或模擬週期
on tick	賒帳；英式非正式
what makes X tick	令某人 / 某系統真正運作的內在機制或動機
ticker — information	股票 / 新聞等持續更新的行情顯示
ticker — heart	心臟；非正式
tick-box	打勾框；亦可指純粹形式化的程序

For your original sentence

> “...it has sentimental value, so it **ticks all the boxes** for me.”

The exact meaning is:

tick all the boxes = 這件外套在我重視的所有方面都符合要求

In the passage, those “boxes” are roughly:

- * looks good ✓
- * practical ✓
- * sentimental value ✓

So:

> **it ticks all the boxes for me**

= **它完全符合我所有重要要求 / 對我來說可算是面面俱到**

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful modern core meanings for `tick`**:

1. **short regular clicking sound / make that sound**
2. **check mark / mark something with a check**
3. **small blood-feeding parasite**
4. **a small unit, increment, or timing step**
5. **informal British: a very short moment**

I would keep **tick all the boxes**, **on tick**, and **what makes X tick** as important fixed expressions; finance/computing uses sit under #4; and **ticker** should stay as a family extension rather than inflate the base-word count.